However, it is said that Abul-Qasim Babur Mīrzā was a weak ruler who was prone to mismanagement. In an instance of a bad decision, he went into battle against Abu Sa‘id Mīrzā.[‡]—an event which was disliked by Husayn Bayqara. He thought to shake hands with Abu Sa‘id Mīrzā. Although Abu Sa‘id was inclined to take him into his service, a rebellion on the part of Husayn Bayqara‘s relative, Sulṭān Awais Mīrzā, son of Muhammad Mīrzā, son of Bayqara Mīrzā, induced Abu Sa’id to arrest Husayn Bayqara and other relatives as a precaution. Eventually, on the plea of his mother, Firuza Begum, he was freed, and he re-joined Abul-Qasim Babur Mīrzā till the latter’s death two years later.[§]

Babur’s Narrative Resumes

It was the winter of AD 1495. Sulṭān Husayn Mīrzā led his army out of Khurasan against Ḥiṣār and went opposite of Tirmiz. Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā brought an army from Ḥiṣār to set them in Timriz. Khusrau Shah strengthened himself in Qunduz and sent his younger brother to help Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā.

Both armies kept looking at each other for the whole winter, lying on opposite banks of Timriz. No crossing happened. But the shrewd and experienced Hussain Mīrzā was not going to leave it that plain. He marched up to the river facing Qunduz straight. He sent Abdul Latif Bakshi with around six hundred serviceable men, down the river to the Kilif ferry. Before Sulṭān Masud could get any sign of them, they had already entrenched themselves on the riverbank.

But even when he heard of it, he did not react as aggresively as expected. He did not march against those who had crossed the river. Instead, he broke up his camp and turned back towards Ḥisār. No one knows if this was suggested by Baqi Changhaniani or his half-brother Wali.

And then, Sulṭān Husayn Mīrzā crossed the river ferociously. He sent Badi‘-al-Zaman Mīrzā, Ibrahim Hussain Mīrzā accompanied by Muhammad Wali Beg, Zunnun Arghun against Khusrau Shah. And against Khultan, he sent Muzaffar Husain Mīrzā accompanied by Muhammad Baranduq Barlas. Then, he made a move towards Ḥiṣār.